

Employment

- 2020-present Assistant Professor in the Department of Information, Risk and Operations Management at the McCombs School of Business at The University of Texas at Austin
- Core member in the Machine Learning Laboratory at UT Austin
 - Affiliated faculty at Oden Institute for Computational Engineering and Sciences at UT Austin
 - Research affiliate, Misinformation & AI at UT Austin
 - Research affiliate at the MIT Media Lab
- 2025-present Courtesy Faculty in the Department of Computer Science at The University of Texas at Austin
- 2024-present Courtesy Faculty in the School of Information at The University of Texas at Austin

Education

- Ph.D. Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, MA, USA**
2017-2020 MIT Media Lab, Human Dynamics Group
- Master of Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, MA, USA**
Science Computer Science at Electrical Engineering and Computer Science Department
2013-2016
- Master of Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, MA, USA**
Science Transportation Engineering at Civil and Environmental Engineering Department
2013-2016

Journals

- [1] **Yan Leng**, Yunxin Sang, and Ashish Agarwal. Reducing Disparity Between LLMs and Humans: Optimal LLM Sample Calibration. Accepted, *Marketing Science*.
- [2] **Yan Leng**, Yijun Chen, Xiaowen Dong, Junfeng Wu, and Guodong Shi. When Behavioral Data Betray Users: A Diagnostic and Protective Framework Against Social Interaction Leakages. *Information Systems Research* (2026).
- [3] **Yan Leng** (lead author), Xiao Liu, Rodrigo Ruiz. Interpretable Recommendations and Parameter-Grounded Explanations with Multi-Graph Attention. Accepted, *Information Systems Research*.
- [4] **Yan Leng*** and Yuan Yuan*. SUVA: A Probabilistic Framework for Auditing LLMs with an Application to Social Preferences. *Information Systems Research* (2026).
- [5] Sandro Lera* and **Yan Leng***. Beyond Pairwise Network Interactions: Implications for Information Centrality. *Information Systems Research* (2025).
- [6] Junyu Cao* and **Yan Leng***. Adaptive Data Acquisition for Personalized Recommendations with Optimality Guarantees on Short-Form Video Platforms. *Management Science* (2025).
- [7] **Yan Leng** and Drew Dimmery. Calibration of Heterogeneous Treatment Effects in Randomized Experiments. *Information Systems Research* (2024).
- [8] Lei Wang, Kemi Ding, **Yan Leng**, Xiaoqiang Ren and Guodong Shi. Private Nash Equilibrium Seeking in Quadratic Network Game. *IEEE Transactions on Control of Network Systems* (2024).
- [9] **Yan Leng**, Xiaowen Dong, Esteban Moro, and Alex Pentland. Long-Range Social Influence in Phone Communication Networks on Offline Adoption Decisions. *Information Systems Research* (2023).
- [10] **Yan Leng**, Tara Sowriraja, Yujia Zhai, and Alex Pentland. Measuring Social Influence Within and Across Multi-dimensional Homophilous Communities. *IEEE Transactions on Knowledge and Data Engineering* (2023).

- [11] **Yan Leng***, Dominiquo Santistevan*, and Alex Pentland. Understanding Collective Regularity in Human Mobility as a Familiar Stranger Phenomenon. *Scientific Reports* (2021).
- [12] **Yan Leng**, Yujia Zhai, Shaojing Sun, Yifei Wu, Jordan Selzer, Sharon Strover, Anfan Chen, Hezhao Zhang, and Ying Ding. Analysis of Misinformation During the COVID-19 Outbreak in China: Cultural, Social and Political Entanglements. *IEEE Transactions on Big Data* (2021).
- [13] **Yan Leng**, Yehonatan Yella, Rodrigo Ruiz, and Alex Pentland. Contextual Centrality: Going Beyond Network Structure. *Scientific Reports* (2020).
- [14] Xiaobing Liu, Xuedong Yan, Feng Liu, Rui Wang, and **Yan Leng**. A Trip-specific Model for Fuel Saving Estimation and Subsidy Policy Making of Carpooling Based on Empirical Data. *Applied Energy* (2019).
- [15] Shaokuan Chen, **Yan Leng**, Baohua Mao, and Shuang Liu. Integrated Weight-based Multi-criteria Evaluation on Transfer in Large Transport Terminals: A Case Study of the Beijing South Railway Station. *Transportation Research Part A: Policy and Practice* (2014).

* Equal contribution.

Refereed CS Conference

- [1] **Yan Leng*** and Trung Nguyen*. Latent Neural Coupling of Risk and Time Preferences in LLMs Mirrors Human Biases. *EC '25: Proceedings of the 26th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation*, 2025.
- [2] Yuanpei Gao, Qi Yan, **Yan Leng**, Renjie Liao. Neural MJD: Neural Non-Stationary Merton Jump Diffusion for Time Series Prediction. *Proceedings of the 39th Annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems*, 2025.
- [3] **Yan Leng**. Can LLMs Mimic Human-Like Mental Accounting and Behavioral Biases? *EC '24: Proceedings of the 25th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation*, 2024
- [4] Xue Yu, Muchen Li, **Yan Leng**, Renjie Liao. Learning Latent Structures in Network Games via Data-Dependent Gated-Prior Graph Variational Autoencoders. *Proceedings of the 41st International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2024.
- [5] Emanuele Rossi, Federico Monti, **Yan Leng**, Michael Bronstein and Xiaowen Dong. Learning to Infer Structures of Network Games. *Proceedings of the 39th International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2022.
- [6] **Yan Leng**, Xiaowen Dong, Junfeng Wu, and Alex Pentland. Learning Quadratic Games on Networks. *Proceedings of the 37th International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*, 2020.

Revisions

- [1] Christina Jeong, Jason Chan, **Yan Leng**, and Yue Guo. Dynamic Latent-State Centrality for Enterprise Social Media: Predicting Sales Performance from Multiplex Communication. Conditional acceptance, *Information Systems Research*.
- [2] **Yan Leng**, Yunxin Sang, Dahai Yu, Binwu Wang, Yang Wang, and Guang Wang. FusionTransNet for Smart Urban Mobility: Spatiotemporal Traffic Forecasting Through Multimodal Network Integration. Minor revision, *Management Science*.
- [3] **Yan Leng**. LLMs' Human-Like Behavioral Biases Emerge from Linear Neural Representations. Revise and resubmit at *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*.
- [4] Junyu Cao*, **Yan Leng***, and Hao Wang*. Revenue-Centered Delivery Time Presentation on Platforms: A Spatial Neural ODE Approach. First-round major revision, *Management Science*.
- [5] **Yan Leng**. When Prompts Matter: Quantifying Prompt Uncertainty and Improving Empirical Inference with LLM-Based Measurement. Major revision, *Management Science*.
- [6] **Yan Leng***, Ernest Liu*, Yifei Ren*, and Aleh Tsyvinski*. The Bullwhip: Time-to-Build and Sectoral Fluctuations. Revise and resubmit, *Journal of Political Economy*.

* Equal contribution.

Working Papers

- [1] Terrence Neumann and **Yan Leng**. Activation-Based Prompt Governance for LLM Agents in Complex Social Contexts.
- [2] **Yan Leng***, Leqi Liu*, and Yunxin Sang*. Too Much of a Good Thing? Managing Congestion from Decentralized AI Delegation. *INFORMS Data Science Workshop Best Paper Award Runner-up*.
- [3] **Yan Leng**. Governing Shared AI Systems: The Personalization–Consistency Frontier in Connected Knowledge Work.
- [4] **Yan Leng** and Wen Wang. Data Governance for Customer-Facing LLMs: Valuation and Selective Unlearning.
- [5] Yunxin Sang, **Yan Leng**, and Ashish Agarwal. User Perception Through LLM: A Theory-driven HyperGraph Framework for Marketing Content Generation. *INFORMS ISS Cluster Best Paper Award; INFORMS Data Science Workshop Best Student Paper Award (2024)*.
- [6] Junyu Cao* and **Yan Leng***. Network-enabled Sequential Data Acquisition for High-dimensional Recommender Systems.
- [7] Junyu Cao* and **Yan Leng***. Learning to Optimize Data Quality for Crowdsourcing Labor Markets: A Human-Algorithm-Collaborative Framework. *INFORMS ISS Cluster Best Paper Award (2022)*.
- [8] **Yan Leng** and Ashish Agarwal. Are Spatial Neighbors Complements or Substitutes? Discovering a Visits-based Local Market Structure.
*Equal contribution.

Research Awards

- April 2026 CBA Foundation Research Excellence Award for Assistant Professors.
- Oct 2025 Best Paper Runner-up at INFORMS Data Science Workshop
- Jan 2025 Best Associate Editor for the ICIS 2024 Track: Data Analytics for Business and Societal Challenges
- Oct 2024 Best Student Paper Award at INFORMS Data Science Workshop.
- Nov 2022 Finalist for Meta People’s Expectations & Experiences with Digital Privacy Request for Proposals.
- Oct 2022 2022 INFORMS ISS Cluster Best Paper Award.
- June 2021 Second prize in INFORMS Revenue Management and Pricing Data-driven Challenge.

Grants

- Oct 2023 - Aug 2025 National Institutes of Health (NIH)’s AIM-AHEAD Consortium Development Program (Received a joint \$1,000,000 Grant with Prof. Ying Ding, Yifan Peng, Watkins Craig, and David Hodge).
- Feb 2022 - Aug 2024 National Science Foundation (NSF) CRII Award (\$154,231).
 - Jan 2026 Tinker research grant award (\$5,000).
 - Feb, 2025 Herb Kelleher Entrepreneurship Center (HKEC) Grant (\$5,000)
 - Feb, 2025 McCombs Research Excellence Grant (\$13,400)
- April 2024 OpenAI Researcher Access Program (\$5,000).
- Nov 2023 UT Austin Research & Creative Grants (\$9,860).
- Oct 2023 McCombs Research Excellence Grant (\$10,000).
- Oct 2023 Research Grant from Herb Kelleher Entrepreneurship Center (\$5,000).
- May 2023 Texas Global Faculty Research Seed Grants (\$10,000).
- March 2023 McCombs Research Excellence Grant (\$10,000).

- Dec 2021 Marketing Science Institute Grant Award (\$15,000).
- March 2021 McCombs Research Excellence Grant (\$10,000).
- Sep 2018 Russell Sage Foundation Grant Award (\$7,899).
- Nov 2016 MIT IDEAS Global Challenge Grant (\$5,000).
- Nov 2016 MIT Sandbox Innovation Fund (\$1,000).
- Aug 2016 Harvard Sustainability Grant (\$1,000).

Teaching Awards

- April 2026 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Gen AI in Business and Social Sciences.
- April 2025 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Intro to Problem Solving and Programming.
- April 2024 2023-2024 Trammell/CBA Foundation Teaching Award for Assistant Professors.
- April 2024 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Intro to Problem Solving and Programming.
- Dec 2023 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Intro to Problem Solving and Programming.
- May 2021 McCombs BBA Faculty Honor Roll for Intro to Problem Solving and Programming.

Professional Service

- 2026- Associate Editor, Agentic AI and Human-Agent Collaboration in Business, Decision Sciences
- 2026- Guest Associate Editor, Information Systems Research
- 2026 Gold Reviewer, International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)
- 2025 - present Editorial Board Member, Information Systems Research
- 2025 Program Chair for INFORMS Data Science Workshop
- 2023, 2024 Associate Editor, International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)
- 2024 Ignite (Short Talk) Session Chairs for Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS)
- 2020 Local Chair for Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS)
- 2020- Reviewer for management journals, including Management Science, Information Systems Research, MIS Quarterly, Production and Operations Management (POMS)
- 2020- Reviewer for computer science conferences, including NeurIPS (Neural Information Processing Systems), ICML (International Conference on Machine Learning), The Web Conference (WWW), AAAI (Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence)